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Video Notes: Skimming and Scanning

Learning goal: Understand the difference between skimming and scanning and know when to use each strategy.

Key Ideas

1. Skimming means reading quickly to understand the main idea.
2. Scanning means looking for specific information such as names, dates, numbers or keywords.
3. Read the title and headings before reading the whole text.
4. Do not translate every word. Focus on meaning.
5. Return to the text only when you need evidence for an answer.

Useful Words

skim – read quickly for the main idea

scan – search for specific information

heading – title of a section

keyword – important word

evidence – information proving an answer

Challenge

Before reading a new text, spend 30 seconds looking only at the title and headings. Predict what the text will be about in one sentence.